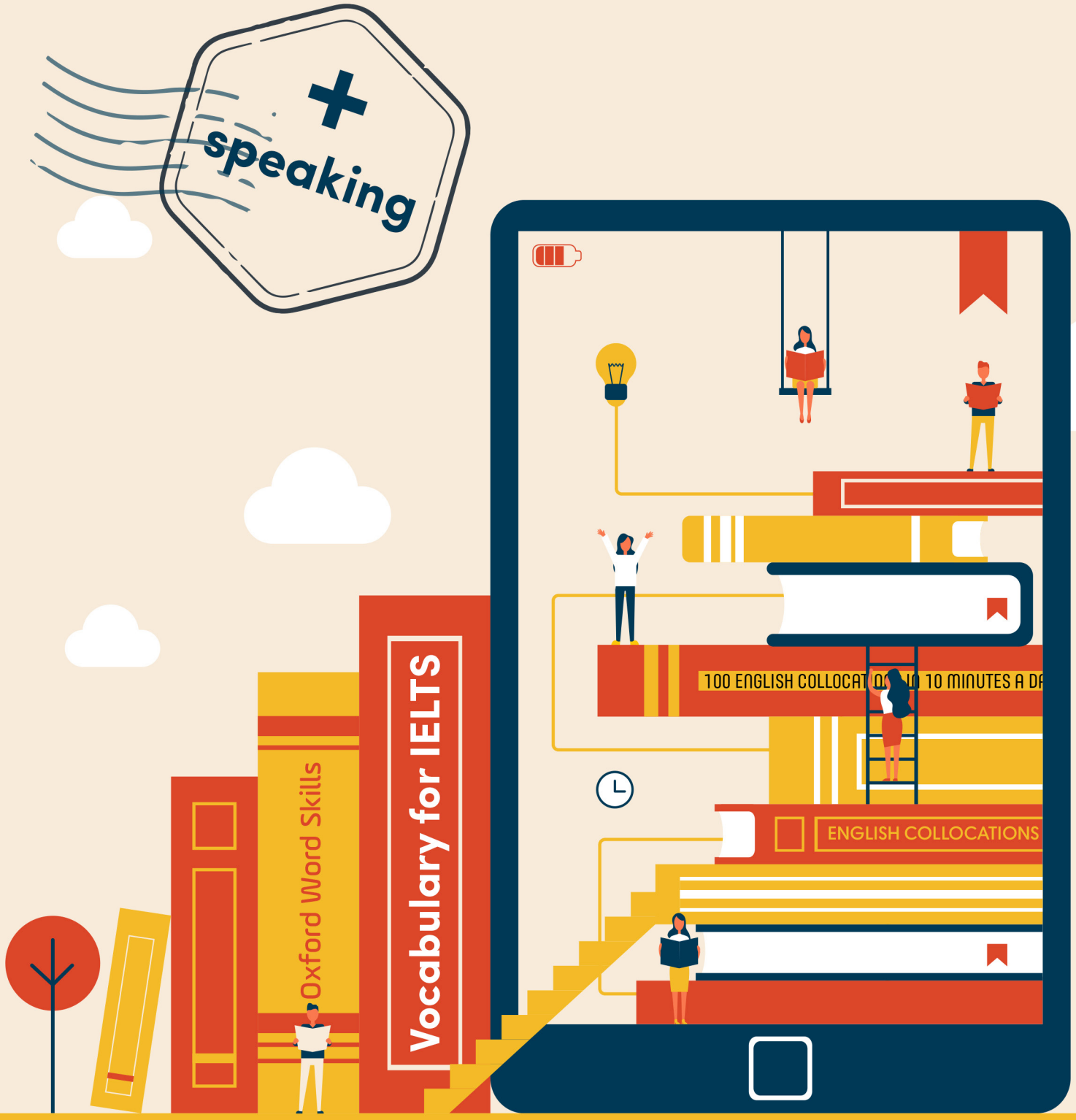
IELTS Up Words!

دوره لغات آیلتس

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Lesson 11: University

University

Hey there! You made it! You are back for another lesson—for the eleventh lesson! Well done! You have completed about one-eighth of the course so far! I am so proud of you! You are indeed a studious person and a diligent student! Can you guess what studious and diligent mean? Listen to my tone and consider the context! They must mean something positive, right? Sometimes, you may not know the exact meaning of a word, but there is a good chance that you can guess its meaning by looking at the context.

Now let's start today's lesson, which is related to the previous one. It is about studying and education, but this time, we will focus on higher education. In this lesson, I am going to talk about what I think about academic studies, and then I will want you to agree or disagree. Okay?

Personally speaking, I think universities should reduce the pressure they put on students. This pressure causes so many mental health and social problems for students. For example, according to an article by the Guardian, British universities are experiencing a surge in student anxiety, mental breakdowns, and depression, and there has been a sharp rise in students dropping out of college. Universities could tackle this problem by including therapy sessions for students whose concentration sometimes wavers in the classroom. Or they could extend the deadlines for dissertations. This way, maybe more students choose to continue studying toward a master's degree or even a Ph.D.

Do you agree or disagree?

Speaking Tip

Paraphrasing: Word Formation

Paraphrasing is the re-statement or re-wording of a paragraph or text while maintaining its meaning.

Paraphrasing in the speaking test is different from the writing test.

On the speaking test, you should answer on the spot because you will lose mark if you spend too much time racking your brain for the perfect synonym or structure.

Don't worry; it gets easier with practice.

One paraphrasing technique is to change the form of a word. For example, if it is a noun in the question or a previous sentence, use it as an adjective now.

Example:

Question: What did you find most interesting about your major?

Answer: What really interested me was that I could immediately apply what I had learned to real-world work.

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
studious (adjective)	spending a lot of time studying and reading	درس‌خوان؛ کتاب‌خوان	synonym: bookish; academic; brainy
diligent (adjective)	someone who is diligent works hard and is careful and thorough	سخت‌کوش	synonym: hard-working; tireless; driven
higher education	college or university education as opposed to school or high school	آموزش عالی	synonym: further education; higher learning; graduate studies; tertiary education
academic studies	used to describe things that relate to the work done in schools, colleges, and universities, especially work which involves studying	مطالعات دانشگاهی؛ مطالعات علمی	academia
students' mental health	students' condition concerning their psychological and emotional well-being	سلامت روانی دانش‌آموزان	mental disorder mental illness
a surge in student anxiety	a sudden increase in student's level of anxiety	افزایش ناگهانی و شدید اضطراب دانش آموزان	a surge in/of a surge of something
mental breakdown	a short phase of a disorder with features of depression or anxiety	فروپاشی روانی	a nervous breakdown
students' concentration sometimes wavers	to waver means to be or become weak or unsteady example: her determination never wavered	گاهی تمرکز دانش‌آموزان به‌هم می‌خورد	waiver or waver?

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
to drop out college	to abandon a course of study at college	ترک‌تحصیل‌کردن	to quit/withdraw from college; a college dropout
to extend a deadline	to provide a longer period for completion of a task	تمدید مهلت	meet a deadline; to miss a deadline; a tight deadline
dissertation	a long piece of writing on a particular subject, especially one written for a university degree	پایان‌نامه؛ رساله	synonym: thesis
continue studying toward a master's degree	to keep studying until you receive your master's degree	ادامهٔ تحصیل تا مقطع کارشناسی ارشد	MA: Master of Arts (linguistics, history, etc.) MS: Master of Science (science, engineering, etc.) a PhD student; a PhD candidate
apply what you learn to real-world work	to use and implement your learning in your real-life work	به‌کاربستن آموزه‌ها در کار (شرایط) واقعی	applicable knowledge "Knowledge without application is a waste of time."

other words/ structures	meaning	translation	other structures
a sharp rise in mental breakdowns	A dramatic increase in the rate of mental illness, in which someone becomes extremely anxious and tired and cannot deal with things	افزایش شدید نرخ آشفتگی ذهنی/بحران روحی/ فروپاشی ذهنی	synonym: nervous breakdown
tackle a problem	to try to deal with a problem	حل یک مشکل	tackle a problem/ issue/question tackle a job/ challenge
answer on the spot	answer it immediately, often without thinking about it very carefully	بی‌درنگ جواب دادن	synonym: answer immediately/ instantly/right away
racking your brain	make a great effort to think of or remember something	به مغز خود فشارآوردن	synonym: think very hard



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